

Mehmet Kekeç

✉ kekecmehmett@gmail.com | 📞 +90 551 120 9232 | 📍 Ankara, Turkey

🌐 Portfolio | 🔗 LinkedIn | 🐙 GitHub

Computer Engineering student at METU with hands-on software engineering experience across optimization, autonomous systems, machine learning, research, and technical team leadership.

EXPERIENCE

ROMER, METU Robotics and Artificial Intelligence Center

Jan 2026 – Present

Research Intern; Undergraduate Researcher (Jan 2026 – Jun 2026)

Ankara, Turkey

- Collaborate in a three-person research team operating synchronized multimodal recording environments for qualitative human–robot interaction research.
- Collected and maintained 900 GB of multimodal data across 17 synchronized recording sessions totaling 3.5 hours.
- Develop a structured gaze-and-pose taxonomy and prepare the dataset and annotation framework for upcoming analysis on robotic social understanding.

ODTÜ Alaz Autonomous Vehicle Team

Jan 2025 – Present

Associate Founder; Software Team Lead (Nov 2025 – Aug 2026)

Ankara, Turkey

- Led a six-person software team building the autonomous driving stack from project inception across ROS 2 Humble, Autoware, Docker, CARLA, and Lanelet2.
- Developed autonomy components spanning YOLOv8 data preprocessing and training, route/path planning, mission-control state transitions, deployment, and CI/CD workflows.
- Qualified for the TEKNOFEST 2025 Robotaxi finals and placed 4th in the closed category at the 2026 RDW Self Driving Challenge.

GDG on Campus METU

Oct 2023 – Jun 2026

Director of Technical Affairs; formerly Assistant AI/ML Team Leader

Ankara, Turkey

- Progressed from Assistant AI/ML Coordinator to Director of Technical Affairs.
- Built and led a 30–40-member active technical contributor pool, overseeing projects, workshops, and community-driven initiatives.
- Expanded the community's unique reach to 400+ members and coordinated training programs issuing 200+ participation certificates.

EDUCATION

Middle East Technical University (METU)

Oct 2023 – Present

B.Sc. in Computer Engineering — CGPA: 3.13/4.00

Ankara, Turkey

Ankara Pursaklar Science High School

Sep 2019 – Jun 2023

CGPA: 95.86/100.00

Ankara, Turkey

PROJECTS

ODTÜ Ambale Airline Optimization | TEKNOFEST 2026 — 1st Place

Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

- Won 1st place in the TEKNOFEST 2026 AI-Powered Airline Optimization Competition as part of a three-person team.
- Contributed across the full project lifecycle, developing a Python, Pyomo, and HiGHS mixed-integer optimization pipeline under hub-capacity, aircraft-rotation, regularity, and route-balance constraints.
- Decomposed 4,770 O-D/day markets, 5,644 flight events, and 7,822 candidate connections into seven subproblems; produced 4,712 selected connections in 212.78 seconds with zero validation violations and a 30.35% objective improvement over the no-shift baseline.

ImmunoTarget | CENTURI Hackathon — 2nd Place

Jun 2026

- Built a T-cell receptor sequence-analysis and embedding pipeline with a six-person international team during a three-day hackathon sprint.
- Led visualization of high-dimensional biological data using PCA, UMAP, and t-SNE to inspect embeddings and communicate model behavior.

Foodage | Sustainable Food Planning Application

Nov 2023 – Mar 2024

- Led development of a TensorFlow and Flutter application that predicts meal quantities from historical demand to reduce food waste.
- Implemented multilingual support, user-provided data import, and personalized predictions for the 2024 Google Solution Challenge.

The Secret Sphere | *Underwater Tourism Vehicle Concept*

Oct 2021 – Aug 2022

- Co-designed a lower-cost spherical underwater vehicle concept featuring a transparent passenger enclosure, ballast-based depth control, and propeller propulsion.
- Specified operation at depths up to 30 meters and produced technical documentation and presentation materials balancing visibility, accessibility, and cost.

SKILLS

Programming: Python, C++, Algorithms, Data Structures

Optimization: Pyomo, HiGHS, Mixed-Integer Programming, Decomposition Algorithms

Robotics & Autonomous Systems: ROS, Autoware, CARLA

AI & Data: PyTorch, TensorFlow, YOLO, OpenCV, Data Preprocessing, PCA, UMAP, t-SNE

Development Tools: Git/GitHub, Linux, Docker

Languages: Turkish, English

REFERENCES

Assoc. Prof. Dr. Erol Şahin

ROMER, Middle East Technical University
erol@ceng.metu.edu.tr

Prof. Dr. Sinan Kalkan

ROMER, Middle East Technical University
skalkan@metu.edu.tr